We recognise that **business innovation is as crucial as product innovation.** Consumers increasingly seek fresh cooked food solutions where freshness, speed, quality and trust converge. Responding to this, your Company launched the **Fresh Food Business**, leveraging ITC's institutional strengths in trusted brands, food sciences, cuisine expertise and digital capabilities. With over 70 cloud kitchens across five cities, the business has grown over 100% in the last three years through a delectable portfolio comprising **Aashirvaad Soul Creations, ITC Master Chef Creations, Sunfeast Baked Creations and Sansho from ITC Master Chef,** which have consistently received top consumer rankings.

> **"In the true spirit of Make in India, nearly 90% of ITC's value addition takes place within the country.... ITC's Bharat Built Manufacturing endeavour is to build globally competitive domestic manufacturing assets, substitute imports, enrich the environment and support sustainable livelihoods."**

Your Company's growing standing in FMCG, powered by the trust of millions of consumers, gives us the confidence to dream boldly — of a future where an ITC product adorns every household in India and makes its mark across continents. ITC's world-class Indian brands will continue to be a significant enduring strength, creating larger value for the enterprise and its stakeholders.

ITC: Powering Make in India for a Viksit Bharat

Your Company's **Bharat Built Manufacturing architecture** has created world-class national assets across **FMCG, Paperboards & Packaging and export-oriented value-added Agri Processing.** Today, ITC's manufacturing ecosystem spans **over 300 factories**, including 45 owned plants, engaging with more than **9,500 MSMEs.** These large investments in modern facilities provide strong levers of competitiveness, resilience and local value-chain development.

In the true spirit of Make in India, nearly 90% of ITC's value addition takes place within the country. The agri and food processing industry has high employment-to-capital intensity. Therefore, your Company's 170 factories in this sector **are a powerful economic multiplier, deepening inclusive farm-to-consumer value chains and linking farmers to domestic and global markets.**

Your Company's confidence in the India story is reflected in its proposed medium-term capex of ₹20,000 crore for the Group in areas that have a multiplier impact. Close on the heels of 8 recently commissioned facilities, 6 new projects are in the pipeline. Your Company's leadership as **India's largest integrated paperboards and paper business** will be reinforced by the forthcoming acquisition of Century Pulp & Paper, raising capacity by over 50% to 1.5 million metric tonnes. The newly established **state-of-the-art Moulded Fibre Products** facility is pioneering complex engineered compostable solutions for single-use plastic substitution for both domestic and global markets. As each of your Company's businesses scales up in line with the ITC Next strategy, its manufacturing ecosystem is poised to expand further, contributing to India's aspiration to be a global manufacturing powerhouse.

Your Company's distributed manufacturing network is also a **vibrant hub of innovation, quality, sustainability and safety besides providing structural competitiveness.** An AI-first digital backbone in ITC's manufacturing facilities enhances efficiency, cost optimisation and responsiveness. Several units now meet nearly 100% of their electricity needs from renewable sources, are Platinum-rated green buildings or have achieved global AWS standards.

In line with ITC's deep commitment to an **Aatmanirbhar Bharat**, your Company is also placing sharper thrust on indigenisation and import substitution **to build structural competitiveness.** Your Company pioneered the **Bharat Fibre chain for its Paperboards business through massive afforestation, substituting imports and saving foreign exchange while creating a green cover, substantial rural livelihoods and larger value in India.** Today, this initiative has greened **nearly 1.5 million acres, generating over 270 million person-days of employment.**

ITC also established the **first-of-its-kind Bleached Chemi-Thermo Mechanical Pulp** Plant at Bhadrachalam, creating domestic capability in specialised pulp, and is now investing in a second BCTMP mill. Additionally, investments have also been made in domestic capsule manufacturing capacity and a Décor Paper plant to substitute imports. These interventions will significantly enhance cost competitiveness while also enabling foreign exchange savings exceeding **₹17,500 crore over the next decade.**

For us at ITC, this is the larger meaning of **Bharat Built Manufacturing** in action — **to build globally competitive domestic manufacturing assets,** substitute imports, enrich the environment and support sustainable livelihoods.

ITC: Supporting Climate Action & Inclusive Growth

I now turn to two defining imperatives of our times — **climate resilience and livelihood generation** — both vital for a sustainable, inclusive and competitive future. For India, climate risks are acute, severely impacting agri-food security, livelihoods, productivity and infrastructure.

While the Government has spearheaded world-leading efforts, the consequences of the climate crisis demand far more urgent, collective and sustained action at scale — globally, nationally and locally.

To my mind, enterprises can take transformational measures to combat climate change and also foster inclusive development. ITC's comprehensive approach addresses climate risks through large-scale programmes aimed at decarbonisation, adaptation, nature-based solutions and circularity, while also implementing a mosaic of solutions for rural empowerment.

What differentiates ITC's sustainability journey is a triad of achievements. First, **Longevity,** that is reflected in decades of sustained environmental impact. Second, **Scale**, which is demonstrated through the massive creation of ecological capital and support to millions of livelihoods. Third, **Integration**,